

AI TAROT PROJECTION

**For people who don't believe in
tarot,
but believe in thinking out loud.**

The cards never predict. They get you talking.



wyc79.github.io/ai-tarot-projection

Runs on your own API key · open source · stores nothing, anywhere

THE IDEA

A projective surface, not a fortune

Three cards go face down before anything is said. You're asked what you see in the one in front of you. Not what it means: what you see.



Projection, not prediction

A flip shows the card's name, never a caption.



You always speak first

What you see in the picture becomes the conversation.



The card is the third object in the room

Pointing at a picture beats “I've been a bit off lately.”



Smith-Waite 1909 · public-domain scans

A studied counseling technique

13/15

participants found a single-session reading personally meaningful

Semetsky, 2005



Clinton (2024)

Tarot as a projective technique in counseling: secular, client-led, no expertise required.



Semetsky (2005, 2006)

The layout as a mediating container; talking through it reduces resistance.



White (2007)

Maps of Narrative Practice: the scaffolding map our question engine runs on.



Ramey, Young & Tarulli (2010)

Vygotsky's zone of proximal development as the mechanism under White's map.

Both tarot papers ship in the repo. Full citations and links in the notes.

Cards are earned, not dealt

1

Everything face down

The whole spread hits the table before a word is said.

2

You read the card first

"What does this feel like it's pointing at, for you?"

3

The reader follows

One observation, one question per turn.

4

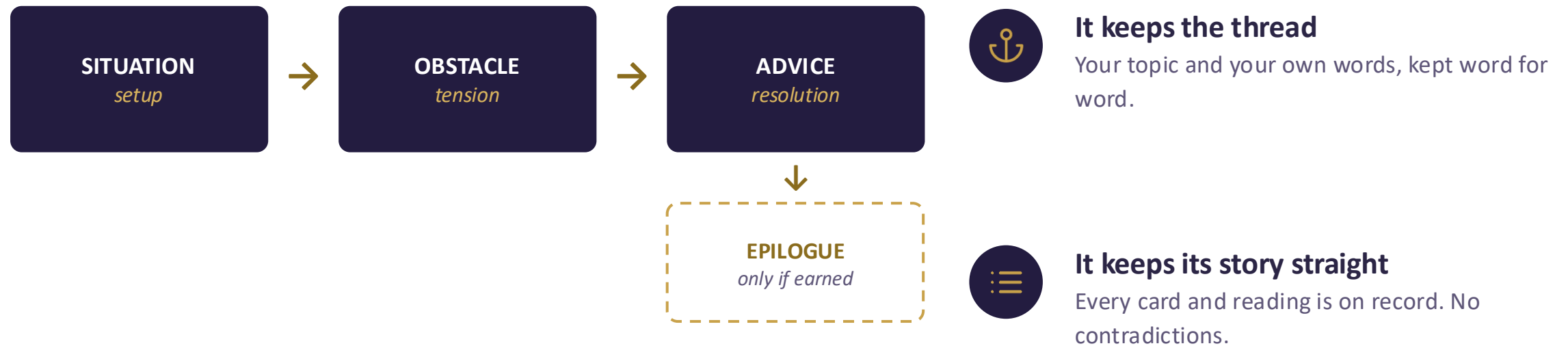
Sharing turns the next card

Cards turn when you say something real, not on a timer.



The earned fourth card: an epilogue that only exists when the reading earned it. Otherwise, *"one card stays with the deck today; it'll be there when you come back."*

The reading knows where it's going



The spread and a story arc are the same shape, so the session steers toward a landing.

Questions climb a ladder, one rung at a time



One rung above you, never two

Two steps out is an answer you'd have to invent.



Two tracks: the picture, and your life

Moving between them is a step of its own.



A dodge is respected

It backs off and asks something smaller, more concrete.



Card flips ride a separate track

Turning a card is earned by depth of sharing, not by ladder height.

The scaffolding map from narrative therapy (White, 2007). The person never hears the levels named.

What the AI reads before each reply

THE RULEBOOK

who the reader is · example readings · the rules · the spread · your topic

*never changes during a session,
so it can be cached: faster, cheaper*

RECENT CONVERSATION

only the last 10 exchanges

*keeps the voice natural;
the facts live in the box below*

THE SESSION SO FAR

your topic, in your words · each card's reading · what this turn should do

*rebuilt fresh every turn; when this and
the chat disagree, this wins*

All of this lives in plain text files. Changing how the reader behaves means editing a file, not shipping new code.

Safe by design, private by construction

Guardrails that scale with what's at stake



Everyday topics

A normal, reflective reading. No predictions, ever.



Serious topics

Medical, legal, money: it says this needs a professional.



Crisis: the tarot voice stops

It answers plainly and points to real help, from turn one.



“That's not it” always wins

Push back and it updates. Disagreement is never “resistance.”

Your key, your choice of path



Direct

Your browser talks straight to the AI provider.



Your own relay

~300 lines of Python you can read in one sitting.



Hosted

Under 140 lines, with no code that could log you.



Tested, not promised

Tests plant a fake key; it must show up nowhere.

What the competition doesn't have

vs. Aluma, TAROGO, Inner Arcana. Validated against their own user reviews.



Cards you earn

Opening up is what turns cards over. Nobody else has this.



One consistent reading

It remembers what it said and never contradicts itself.



Provably private

You can read the code and run the tests. Not a promise.



Swappable decks

A deck is a data file. Drop in your own; the app doesn't change.

Where this goes next



Custom-designed decks

A new deck is art and text, not code: Marseille, Chinese, original art.



Zodiac integration

The audiences overlap. A birth-chart layer, plus a daily card ritual.



Memory that's earned

It remembers you more with each visit. Stored only on your device.



Beyond tarot

The same engine can power journaling or any talk-through-a-picture tool.

Already shipped: use your own physical deck. Only the card's name is ever sent.

*“One card stays with the deck today;
it'll be there when you come back.”*

AI Tarot Projection

Open source. Runs on your own key. Stores nothing, anywhere.
The deck never tells you anything. It gets you to say it.

Try it: wyc79.github.io/ai-tarot-projection

Thank you

